

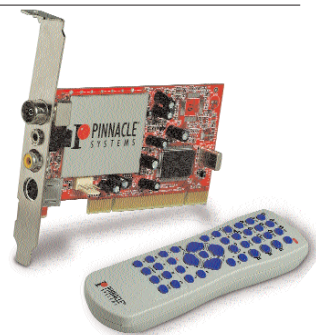
Pinnacle PCTV Stereo

As long as the absence of FM Stereo doesn't have you complaining, the PCTV Stereo is a good buy. The new Pinnacle PCTV Stereo is an entry-level TV tuner, with a universal tuner: it can tune to PAL, SECAM and NTSC signals. It is a sleek, silicon-based card, which, unlike others, doesn't interfere with the adjacent PCI slot during installation.

The Pinnacle PCTV Pro, with its FM Tuner, still remains one step ahead; this one is cheaper, though, and provides similar quality.

Hardware installation was a breeze: all we had to do was plug in the card and make the necessary connections. The software bit was just as easy—the wizard hand-holds you throughout. The card scanned channels perfectly—manual fine-tuning to increase clarity was not needed.

PCTV has its own proprietary software, plus a trial version of Studio8 that



lets you fiddle around with captured content.

Performance was on par with the other Pinnacle cards we've reviewed—content capturing was almost as good as that of the Pinnacle PCTV Plus and Pro, and no frames were dropped. The highest resolution supported for capturing is 720 x 576, which is MPEG-II high-quality.

SPECIFICATIONS

PCTV Stereo low-profile PCI board, max resolution captured: 720 x 576, audio cable, IR remote control

Pinnacle PCTV Stereo B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 3,500

Contacts: Pinnacle India

Phone: 011-26445915

E-mail: mgupta@pinnaclesys.com

Web site: www.pinnacle.com

Brother MFC-8820D

The enormous Brother MFC8820D is competitively priced. Looking at its unique features and good performance, it's best suited to busy office departments such as accounts, Public Relations and sales.

Apart from the usual functions, the unit can also do duplex printing, scan 50 pages using the ADF (automatic document feeder), and broadcast fax to as many as 390 locations.

The MFC-8820D is supported by a 250-sheet cassette, with an option to plug in another. The output tray holds 150 pages.

The scanner turned out decent images. It was quick too—at 600 dpi, the test image scan took just four minutes; other MFDs took

well over six minutes. The scanner can scan legal-size documents at 600 x

2,400 dpi resolution.

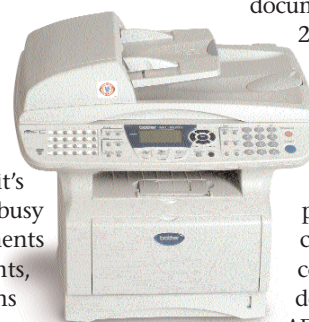
Fax is sent and received at 33.6 kbps. The copier scans at 1,200 x 600 dpi, and can print 99 copies. You can also make copies of multiple documents using ADF, adjust contrast,

set quality and also enlarge or reduce document size.

The copy function also returned good results when dealing with text-based documents, but images weren't copied well at all. This is probably the biggest minus for the unit.

SPECIFICATIONS

2400x600 dpi print resolution, 250-sheet paper cassette, 1,200 dpi resolution scanner, 50-sheet legal-size ADF unit, 33.6 Kbps fax modem, 40-speed dial, 32 MB memory, 18.1 Kgs



Price: Rs 41,000 + taxes

Contact: Godrej & Boyce Mfg Co Ltd

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Web site: www.brother.com

Brother MFC-8820D B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

HP Business Inkjet 1100D

Humongous! That's what pops into your head when you see the new HP Business Inkjet 1100D printer. Though recent times have seen low-profile printer designs, the 1100D distinguishes itself by

being the opposite.

This is certainly an expensive printer, but business pedigree sets it apart. Buy it if your office prints about 5,000 pages a month.

Performance-wise, the 1100D was blazing fast and displaced most of the printers in our recent comparison. Its unbeatable speed in most of the tests saw it coming on top. As far as quality goes, it wasn't the best, but managed to give professional-looking prints.

The HP 1100D carries with

it all the features essential for a business environment. The printer has four ink cartridges, and the print head for each comes separately, for maximum flexibility. These, however, might add up to the overall cost, increasing the total cost of ownership.

You get 8 MB of memory—enough for most print jobs.

The printer is network-ready and can be hooked up to HP's JetDirect print servers that support many network operating systems, not just Microsoft's suite of OSes.

SPECIFICATIONS

1200x1200 dpi resolution, 8 MB RAM, 150 sheet paper tray, USB and parallel ports



Price: Rs 14,299

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HP Business Inkjet 1100D B-	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶